Tooth Be Told, I Love Her

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/41059389.

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General Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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by ResFlower

Summary

Perfuma laughs indulgently. "I don't think little Frosta is quite ready for the task, but you'll be in good hands Catra's great at what she does."

Adora nods, half paying attention as she finishes put the final lines of her health form. "Yeah, I'm sure."She mumbles absentmindedly. Just as she's about to return to her seat she hears someone clear their throat.

"Adora?"The woman calls out.

Adora just about drops the clipboard. The woman is gorgeous, all tan skin and dark freckles, hips canted to the side as she puts a hand on her waist.

The woman gives her a questioning look, her cute nose slightly upturned as she looks Adora up and down. "You are Adora right?"

Adora snaps out of it. "Yes!Right!Adora!That's me."Her voice pitching high as she puts the clipboard on Perfuma's desk. She ignores Perfuma's giggles.

"Alright 'that's me, Adora' my name's Catra. Let's get you some x-rays and then your cleaning."She motions for Adora to come with her.

OR

Adora really wants to ask out her dental hygienist. Now if only she could find the right time to ask. The Dental Hygienist AU no

one asked for.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Bow has nagged and harangued her about getting a cleaning since the dawn of time. Normally, Adora has found creative ways to get around the problem. But now that Bow has his own dental office, he pulled out his best puppy eyes saying that if Adora wanted to support his *dreams* she would get her damn teeth cleaned.

So here she is, in the cheerful little waiting room, dreading getting her teeth scrutinized and judged like some two-bit racehorse.

"Adora?" Perfuma calls gently from behind the receptionist's desk. "I need you to fill out some forms and then you'll be set for your cleaning."

She walks up and grabs the clip board, opting to stand and fill in the information there, leg bouncing as she does so. "Did Bow hire Frosta as a dental hygienist?" She cracks, referring to Glimmer's little cousin who was still in college.

Perfuma laughs indulgently. "I don't think little Frosta is quite ready for the task, but you'll be in good hands. Catra's great at what she does."

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"Alright 'that's me, Adora,' my name' s Catra. Let's get you some x rays and then your cleaning."She motions for Adora to come with her.

Adora follows along dumbly, making a valiant effort to not let her eyes trail down as she follows Catra. How can she look so good in *scrubs* of all things?

She pulls to a stop, turning to eye Adora again. "Alright, blondie let's get you set."She reaches forward and grabs the lead apron draping it across Adora's shoulders. Her shoulder burns where Catra touched her.

She then follows her to the xray machine which looks like a weird spherical thing. "Since this is a new of fice you might not have experience with an xray machine like this. Y ou are going to bite on this"She points to a plastic bit covered in a new plastic wrap"and then you have to stay still while the machine spins and take a 360 x ray alright"?

Adora stares blankly at the hygienist, wondering how she's supposed to retain anything when she's looking at her like that. Adora notices she has two eye colors, one blue and the other a deep caramel.

The woman smirks. "Y ou're not a biter, are you"?

Adora flushes glad the apron would block out some of the redness on her neck. "Um, Iwhat"?—

She points back to the xray machine. "Bite. Here."She says it slowly like Adora's an idiot. Which to be fair, she hasn't really disproven up to now.

She does as she's asked, slowly wrapping her lips around the plastic. She feels Catra’s hand come up under her chin, tilting her head slightly. She keeps her eyes forward, refusing to lean into the soft hand. "There you are, princess. Now , just stay still for me and I'll be right back."

She hears the machine beep loudly as the x-ray machine whirls around her head. Once it stops, Catra returns and removes the lead apron. She leads her to sit in the big dental chair, turning on the overhead light and bringing it closer as she leans Adora back.

"I'm gonna go get some stuff. Give me a minute." She excuses herself.

Adora takes a deep breath the moment Catra’s out of sight. Would it be weird if she asks her out? I would probably be weird. She's barely been able to say two words to her, Catra probably thinks she's a total moron.

Before she knows it, Catra's back in the room, setting a bunch of tools on a metal tray. She places a disposable paper apron across Adora’s chest.

Adora opens her mouth to ask Catra something, anything really, but then she finds the suction tube in her mouth.

"So, what do you do for a living, blondie?" She asks as she turns back with a scary-looking hook. Before she can answer the hook is in her mouth scraping at her teeth.

Catra has this playful gleam in her eye that makes Adora narrow hers. Catra ends up laughing, pulling the thing out of her mouth. "Sorry , it was just too easy . Give me a two-word answer so I can get to work."

"I'm a fitness instructor ," Adora says awkwardly around the suction tube.

Catra eyes her briefly again before putting the thing back in her mouth. "I bet you are."

Adora makes a choking noise that shouldn't be possible while Catra's scraping at her teeth. The hygienist lets out a soft laugh again, the corners of her eyes crinkling behind her safety glasses.

"I've been a hygienist for about three years now . Bow poached me from my last office with a raise, Fridays off, and a promise of coffee every morning." She says of fhandedly as her eyes focus on Adora. "Still waiting on the cof fee." She rolls her eyes.

This was actually kind of nice if she ignores the loud noises and mild pain of having her teeth messed with. Catra's really funny, occasionally making smart comments to Adora as she works. She has such an intense look as her eyes wander Adora's face, switching tools as she cleans Adora's teeth. She would have come to the dentist earlier if she knew it meant she could gawk at a pretty girl for half an hour.

Adora hasn't felt this attracted to someone in so long. It's not just that Catra's gorgeous, there's just this spark of wit and intelligence that Adora enjoys. She'd really like to spend time with her without ten different brushes up in her gums.

For a moment, Catra furrows her brow and pulls out a weird little stick with some lines on it. She slides it under her gums which feels weird but not painful. She makes a noise of discontent but otherwise stays quiet.

They finally finish and she pulls Adora's chair up. Adora grips the arms of the chair briefly. She really wants to see Catra again.

"Alright, blondie. I'm going to level with you." She starts before Adora can ask her out. "Whatever care you're giving those teeth? Not working for you." She says flatly .

Adora blushes as Catra gives her an unimpressed stare. "You have two cavities that need fixing, and you have some gum inflammation, which is the more serious issue. If you don't get that under control, it might lead to gingivitis and your teeth falling out." She turns away and starts jotting some notes in Adora's chart. "No one is going to hire a fitness instructor without a winning smile, alright champ? So, you need to get an electric toothbrush if you don't have one and either floss or use a water pik. I'm not too choosy about which one."

Adora deflates under Catra's critical gaze. How is she supposed to ask her out after that dressing down?

"Hey, Catra! How's Adora doing?" Bow pops into the room looking between the two women.

Catra gives him a polite smile. "She's good! I used the probe to check her gum inflammation. Some of them where about a three so that's the biggest thing you might want to follow up with. No bone loss on the x-ray though." She reports effortlessly, barely looking up from the chart. "Oh! Also, two cavities but they're pretty small. Shouldn't cause too much trouble."

She's so professional and charming. God, how is Adora such a mess over a girl she's been around for half an hour?

"Okay Adora, why don't you come with me, and we can set up an appointment to deal with the cavities." Bow offers with a big grin.

Adora looks up at Catra torn. She isn't going to ask her out in front of her boss that's just too much. She sighs quietly to herself. "Bye, Catra." She tries to somehow convey her interest by just looking at the woman.

Her smile softens and she pulls a loose curl back into her cap. "Bye Adora. Remember to floss." She takes a baggy with a toothbrush and some floss, her fingers brushing Catra's for a moment.

As she walks away, Bow puts a hand on her shoulder. "So? Cleaning wasn't that bad right?" He needles.

"No, it was way better than expected." She says thinking of Catra's little smirks and glittering eyes.

"Alright, thats what I like to hear. Set something up with Perfuma for next week so you can get those cavities taken care of." He says as he walks her to the front of the office.

"You got it, boss." Adora salutes him.

Bow rolls his eyes but leaves her be as she gets to Perfuma.

"I have cavities and need an appointment." She reports dutifully. She looks around at all the cute art and plants that liter the office, recognizing it to be a mix of Glimmer and Perfuma's touch.

"Alright well, we can squeeze you in for next Tuesday at 1 o clock. Does that work?" She says after scrolling through the calendar.

She thinks about seeing Catra again next week. "Yeah, that works."

Tuesday can't come fast enough.

Adora comes a little more prepared today. She's wearing her tightest five-inch shorts and racer back shirt, a normal ensemble for work. If she has enough time to change between her dentist appointment and her shift but chose to come in her gear already, well, no one else had to know.

She's kind of regretting it, because she's feeling cold, her skin pebbled over because of the temperature. But if it gets Catra to notice her, it'll be well worth it. She smiles brightly as she waits by the reception desk.

"I've never seen someone so happy to get their cavities filled," Perfuma notes dryly.

Adora tinges pink. "Well, you know. I'm just happy to get it over with." She fibs.

Before Perfuma can respond a towering woman shows up from the depths of the office. Perfuma gives her a big flirty smile, a look Adora had never seen on her friend's face before. She raises an eyebrow at her which makes her clear her throat and avert her eyes.

"This is Scorpia. She'll be taking care of you today." Adora looks at the friendly woman and then back at Perfuma.

"Oh I thought—" She bites her lip and shakes her head. She didn't need Perfuma connecting the dots on her silly crush. "Nevermind. Nice to meet you." She offers instead.

The tall woman smiles wide at Perfuma sending her a warm glance before settling on Adora. "Howdy! How are you today? We can take care of those cavities in a jiffy!"

She motions for Adora to follow along but not before sending a flirty smile Perfuma's way. She'll have to ask her friend about that later.

"Alright-ee why don't you sit back and relax while I get prepped huh?" She started quickly putting on her safety glasses and setting up her tools.

"So um, do you know if the hygienist is in today?" Adora asks tentatively.

Scorpia nods enthusiastically. "Yeah, Catra's in! I think she's leaving in about an hour, though I forget why." She turns to look at Adora. "Why do you ask?"

"Oh! Um, no reason I was just curious." She says lamely.

"I can always tell her you asked about her if you don't run into her ." She offers cheerily.

"No, no, no, Scorpia. That's totally fine, I don't want to be a bother ." She panics, looking up at the muscle-bound woman.

She presses her lips together. "Did you do something to my wildcat?" Suddenly the drill she's holding looks way more menacing than before.

"Wildcat?" She asks confused. W ere Scorpia and Catra dating? She thought there was something between Scorpia and Perfuma but maybe she read the vibes wrong.

God, it would be just like her to accidentally ask about a girl to her girlfriend. She's really about to get pummeled by a dentist, isn't she?

"Catra is my best friend so if you were rude to her , I won't stand for it." Scorpia huf fs, crossing her arm with the drill still in hand.

Adora feels relief. Before she can dissuade Scorpia from the notion that she's somehow offended Catra, the woman in question walks in with a bright smile.

"Hey Adora." She greets her as she sits in the chair next to Scorpia's.

"Catra! Hi." She tries not to blush but it's an impossible task.

"Did Adora do anything to upset you?" Scorpia asks Catra point blank with a terse tone.

Catra stares back in confusion. "No, I met her last week when I gave her a cleaning. Role model patient." She cuts her eyes to Adora. "Have you been misbehaving?" She leers. The way her voice drops and the smirk that plays at the edges of her lips should be *illegal*.

"She was asking about you," Scorpia says, confused.

Catra's smirk only widens. "Oh, princess. You've been asking about me?"

Adora would like to disappear now. "Um, I wanted to say hi. If you were around. You know." She clears her throat and looks up at Scorpia. She looks between the two of them suspiciously.

"Well, now you've said hi. Anything else you want to say?" She goads.

The overhead light feels like a spotlight in an interrogation room. That's what Adora blames when she swats away the easy opening.

"Um no. Just wanted to say hi." She nods to herself.

Catra looks at her for a moment then shrugs. "Suit yourself, blondie." She looks up at her friend who looked at the whole exchange with wide eyes. "Take care of princess here, yeah?"

Scorpia nods mutely while furrowing her brow. Catra walks away leaving an awkward silence behind.

"Alright, Adora. Let's see about these cavities."

Scorpia works in silence, periodically explaining what she's doing or chatting idly. Every once and a while she'll look down at Adora with a questioning look before humming to herself and working again.

"Okay, you're all set! Won't need to be back until you're next cleaning which should be about six months." She informs as she pulls off her glasses.

"Okay great. Thanks, Scorpia." She offers her hand to shake as she gets up.

She shakes her hand holding it for a moment too long. "Catra is a very special person alright? Be good to her." Her voice contains a light warning.

Adora doesn't back down. "So is Perfuma." She counters. The other woman suddenly looks so shy, turning red as a crab.

"She is." She agrees softly. "So we understand each other?"

Adora nods softly and grunts in surprise when the big woman envelops her in a hug. She pats her back awkwardly.

As she makes her way to the front desk, she passes by Catra who is getting ready to leave. She gives her a small smile which she answers with a dorky wave. She keeps watching her out of the corner of her eye as she makes her way to the reception desk.

"Perfuma, do you think I can get a cleaning in three months." She blurts out.

Perfuma furrows her brow. "Adora, your insurance won't cover it for another six—"

Adora shakes her head. "I'll pay. I'll just be this once, right? She's not being weird, just proactive about her dental health.

"Adora, I'm not sure I understand." Perfuma starts.

Adora shakes her head. "Look, Perfuma. I *really* need you to just work with me here."

She glances back to see Catra laughing. She's taken off her cap and it's the first time she sees her hair voluminous and wild curls that roll down her back. It makes Adora's heart throb.

"Oooohhh." Perfuma intones knowingly, eyes switching between Adora and Catra. "Just this once." She warns.

Adora allows herself a relieved smile. "Thanks, Perfuma you're the best."

"What are you up to?" Bow actually looks angry which is really weird.

Adora drops her gym bag in the locker. "Today I'm teaching a spinning class at four and then I'm booked for personal training clear through eight." She explains, curious as to what has Bow in such a mood.

He shakes his head, lips still pressed together. "No, not that." He makes an impatient noise in the back of his throat. "I saw you booked another dental appointment. And Perfuma won't let me cancel it."

She tries to hide behind the locker door. "Oh. That. Well, I thought you'd be glad. You know I'm supporting your business." She bites her lip and bends over to tie her shoes.

"Adora, you hadn't gone for a cleaning in over a year and a half. You want me to believe you want one in three months with nothing weird going on?" Bow gave her a disappointed dad stare.

She caves like a house of cards. "Fine! I just want to see Catra again." She admits. "She seems really cool, and I want to get to know her better."

Bow looks at her in disbelief. "Adora! You couldn't just ask her out like a normal person instead of making unnecessary medical appointments."

"I tried okay, but it's hard to ask someone out when you can't talk for most of the time you spend together." She hisses in frustration.

Bow nods in acknowledgment. "Alright, I see your point. How is another appointment going to fix that?"

She runs a hand through her hair, redoing her ponytail. "I don't know! I'll work up the courage to ask before she starts messing with my mouth."

Bow raises an eyebrow at her. "Look. I'm running a business, not a charity. I'm not letting you pay for an unnecessary cleaning out of

pocket."Adora tries to protest but she's silenced by Bow's thunderous look. "You aren't paying for it and that's final. But this is the last time you try to use my dental office as a dating service."

Adora looks down and nods, sufficiently cowed by her best friend.

"And you're telling Glimmer about this. I'm not getting yelled at because you haven't told her."He tacks on.

Adora looks up in alarm. "Bow she has no chill!She'll go to Catra and embarrass me."She protests. She really will have no chance to shoot her shot if Glimmer gets involved.

"Back so soon, princess?"Catra asks as she leads her into the dental chair once again.

"Yeah, you know. Just trying to take care of my teeth."Her laugh is a little too on edge to be considered natural.

Catra gives her an odd look but ignores Adora's comment. She has Adora open her mouth as she looks around but she doesn't make a move to grab anything except the little mirror while she checks on Adora's molars.

She sighs, leaning back as she flips off the overhead light. "I'm not giving you a cleaning today. You don't need one and I can't just have you spending money on this in good conscious. Come back in another three months when you're supposed to."

Adora freezes in the chair . She never expected Catra to refuse to do the cleaning.

"Who even told you that you needed another cleaning?"She asks with a furrowed brow taking a seat as she pulls of her safety glasses and gloves.

"Bow ."She says quickly before she snaps her mouth closed. Bow' s going to *kill* her.

She eyes Adora for a moment before nodding her head. "I'll have a talk with him. "I'm not okay with recommending unnecessary procedures to patients, even if it's something as simple as a cleaning."She says stif fly.

"I think this is a misunderstanding. "I'll talk to Bow . I promise he is a super standup guy I must have said something that made him think I needed my teeth cleaned."

Adora stands up from the chair, new waves of embarrassment and guilt flooding her as she realizes she might have just jeopardized her friend's reputation in front of a work colleague.

"Alright, well. f you think so."She says uncertainly .

"I'm going to go now ."Adora practically bolts put of the room.

"Adora wait!"She calls out. Adora makes herself slow down. Catra grabs her hand. "Is everything okay?"She eyes her with concern.

Adora nods, knowing she must be acting strange as for as Catra's concerned. "I'm great. "I'm sorry to have wasted your time."

"It's fine. No big deal."She waves her hand dismissively . "It was nice to see you anyways."

That makes Adora's heart clench. "It was great to see you too, Catra."

She isn't sure how things got so awkward so fast, but she swears she's staying away from the dental office until it blows over.

She comes back a week later.

Bow happens to be near the front desk, eyeing her critically. "Adora this is a place of business! If I catch you"—

Adora holds up a hand the other on her cheek. "I have a real toothache this time. I can't even close my mouth"—

"Y ou known for faking toothaches, princess." She hears a teasing voice call out.

"No!" She says in a knee-jerk way . Bow gives her a disappointed stare. "Maybe." She of fers weakly.

In the beginning, she briefly thought about it but decided it was too desperate. She'd resigned herself to wait another three months before potentially showing her face back at the dental office, but her teeth had other plans.

Catra eyes her amusedly for a moment before her eyes flicker with concern. "Y our jaw is swollen." She notes.

"It hurts." Adora pouts. It feels like there's a poker going through one of her molars.

Catra's eyes leave Adora and go to Bow. "Instead of yelling at your friend, how about you do dentist things?" She suggests.

"Right. Y eah." Bow looks uncomfortable for a moment. "Sorry , Dor . Let me get a look at that." She sits down and Bow reclines her back as she snaps on his gloves. "I really am sorry ." He of fers again quietly , big brown eyes shining with guilt.

She waves him off. "It's no big deal. I've been acting like an idiot. I get why you thought I might pull a stunt like that."

He quickly looks around her mouth, making a noise of understanding. "Okay , so you cracked a tooth and I think you might have the beginnings of an abscess. We are gonna flush it out and see what we can do about the tooth."

t felt like it took forever , and it hurt like a bitch but Bow finally did everything he could for her molar. He sends her home with a prescription for 800 mg of ibuprofen as if she can't just use the over-the-counter kind.

"Hey Adora." Catra walks up to her cautiously , eyes on the side of her face. "How are you feeling?"

"Stupid." She says bluntly . "I was bothering me for a few days, and I thought it would take care of itself."

Catra snorts. "I feels like you've been around here enough the last few months to know it doesn't quite work that way ."

"You'd think I'd learn." She chuckles.

They sat in silence for a moment. Adora eyes Catra. She's clearly done for the day, her cap removed as well as her gloves, looking tired and rumpled but somehow still gorgeous.

"I'm sorry about the last time we saw each other ." She offers quietly .

Catra's eyes snap to hers. "Adora, don't"—

"Please let me explain." She says. "Bow didn't tell me to get the cleaning, I set up the appointment with Perfuma." She eyes Catra carefully. "I wanted to see you again. I set up the appointment to have a chance to ask you out."

To her surprise, Catra smiles at her. "That's really dumb. And really cute." She reaches out and grabs Adora' s hand. "I would have said yes the first day you know."

Adora's jaw drops. "Really?" She kind of thought Catra would write her off as a loser with all the fumbling she's been doing around her.

"Yeah, really." Her eyes were shining as she squeezed Adora's hand.

She takes a step closer, smiling widely down at the woman she hadn't stopped thinking about for months.

"Do you still want to?" She asks, chest puffed up. Catra nods with a raised eyebrow, clearly signaling for Adora to just get on with it. Adora clears her throat. "Uh, wanna go on a date? There's this really nice seafood place on the pier I really want to take you to." She gets the invitation out without stuttering which is a victory in itself.

"Sure, princess. Pick me up tomorrow at eight."

Four Months Later

"Stop hovering Catra. She's fine." Bow gives her an indulgent smile, clearly enjoying how paranoid the usually unflappable dental hygienist was.

"I wouldn't be hovering if you'd let me stay with her while you and T rapt did the surgery," Catra mutters crossly.

"You can't be in the room if you're family." He reminds her.

Catra can feel her cheeks redden. "We've been dating for a few months. Bow, it's not like we're married."

"Feels like it sometimes." He mutters under his breath. Catra shoves his shoulder because he deserves it.

"Can I see her or not?" She demands outright glaring at her boss.

Bow holds his hands up in surrender. "Yes yes, just remember she's still under the effects of nitrous oxide so—"

"Yeah, yeah, she might be loopy from the laughing gas. Got it. Let me in!"

He laughs and she squeezes by him catching sight of her beautiful girlfriend. She's resting her eyes, taking deep breaths as she

reclines in the dental chair. The sight warms her.

They hadn't been dating long but Adora is already so much more than Catra ever expected. At first, she just thought the girl was wicked hot and kind of dorky but she's since realized it doesn't stop there. Adora's kind, sweet, thoughtful, and probably the best girlfriend she's ever had.

Catra's pretty sure she loves her. Now if only she'd get around to telling the blonde. She's thought about telling her but what if the blonde thinks it's too soon? She puts the thought out of her head as she looks down at her swollen cheeks.

She sits next to her, gently putting her hand on her arm. "Adora." She calls gently, trying not to startle her. Adora opens her eyes slowly, her eyes sluggish and dilated in the way only drugs could cause.

"Hmm..." She hummed as her eyes focus on Catra. She smiles dopily at her. "You look like my girlfriend." She says voice tinged with wonder.

Catra laughs shaking her head.

"Aww, you laugh like her too! She's so hot. Her name is Catra." She informs seriously, head drooping a bit to the side as she continues to babble. "She makes me hot chocolate and gives me forehead kisses. And lets me be the little spoon." She furrows her brow. "People think I can't be the little spoon because of my muscles, but that's not true! Catra lets me!"

She tries to hold her laugh back but it's getting harder the sillier Adora gets. "Of course, Dora." She says indulgently.

Adora's eyes refocus on her. "Look no offense because you're like really *really* hot and all but I only have eyes for Catra." She huffs. "Because, you know, I love her." She giggles to herself. "I love her sooooo much." She continues to giggle.

Meanwhile, Catra's heart is pumping through her chest. Did Adora mean it or was it just the drugs talking? She takes a deep breath before tugging on her hand. "C'mon baby , we have to go home."

Adora fusses at that. "I'm only going home with Catra." She can barely talk around the gauze in her mouth, muf fling everything she's saying.

Catra rolls her eyes. "I am Catra alright? I've got you Dor ."

Adora eyes her for a moment. "I'm being embarrassing right?"

Catra flashes her a smile. "Oh yes, princess. Let' s go."

She manages to get Adora into the car and to her apartment before she passes out. Catra stays over, through the next day , carefully tending to Adora by feeding her lukewarm soups and ice cream and patiently letting her mope and whine about the pain.

She's sitting on the couch wrapped in three blankets when she suddenly speaks up. "I meant it, you know ."

Catra looks up from the water bottle she was refilling for her girlfriend. "Meant what, babe?"

Adora looks at her impossible soft from under her big eyelashes. "I love you, Cat. I have for a while."

Catra sets down the water bottle and joins Adora on the couch. "Y eah?" She breathes feeling her blood rushing in her head.

Adora nods trying to smile as best as she can through the inflammation.

"I love you too 'Dor ." She says back, easy as breathing. Adora laughs, a joyous sound as she wraps her arms around Catra.

Then she's pouting. "I really want to kiss you right now ." She grumbles as she cuddles in close. Catra places a soft kiss on her lips

although it's not what they both want.

"It's your fault for confessing when your mouth is out of commission." Catra teases.

"I'm going to make it up to you. With interest. So many kisses you won't know what to do with them."Adora threatens still clinging to Catra with all her might.

Catra gives her another soft kiss, this time on her forehead. "I can hardly wait Dor."

End Notes

This is also Twitter's fault if you want to see the tweet that started it all click the link lol. Ihad a fun time writing this!Ihope you all enjoy it too :)

Kudos and comments make me super happy if you'd like to share!Also follow me on Twitter.

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